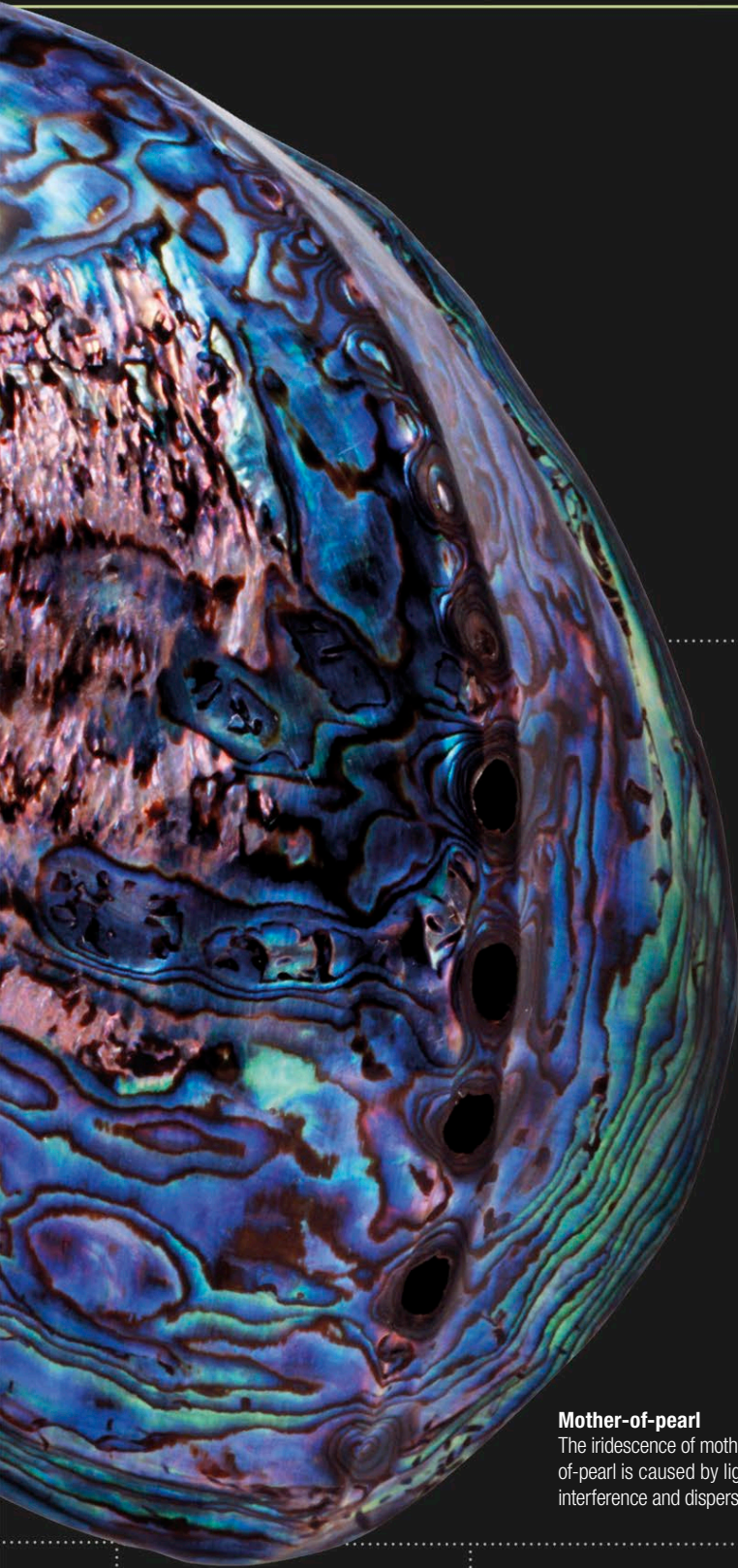
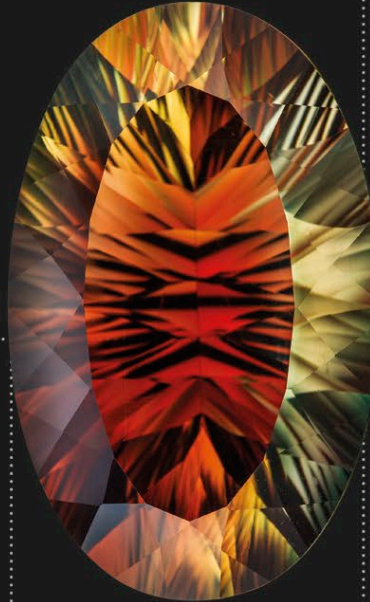




### Mother-of-pearl

The iridescence of mother-of-pearl is caused by light interference and dispersion.



### Sunstone

This stone's glittering finish, called aventurescence, is caused by tiny inclusions of red copper or hematite.



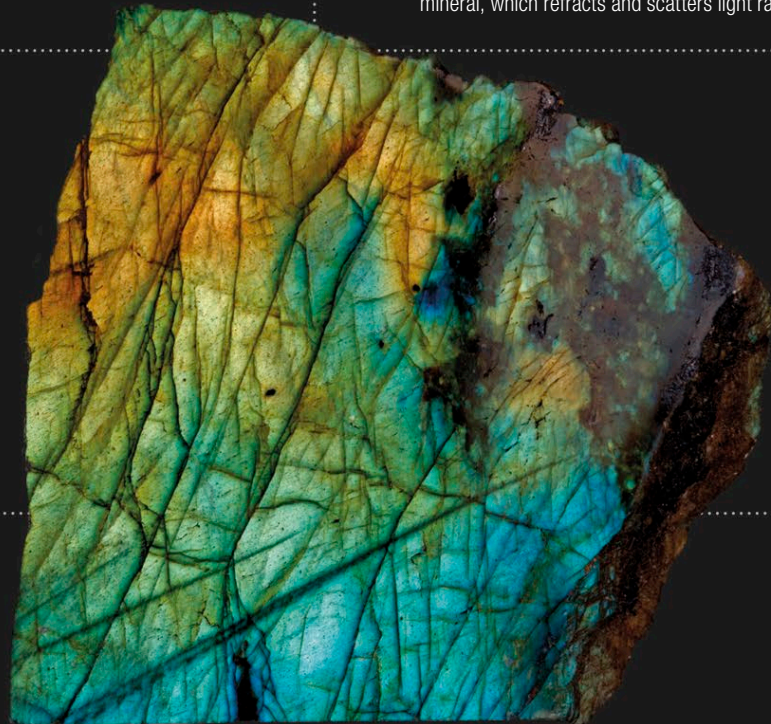
### Common opal

Common opal is less sought-after than precious opal (far left), but can still be beautifully coloured, as here.



### Moonstone

Moonstone displays an effect called adularescence, caused by the unusual, layered structure of the mineral, which refracts and scatters light rays.



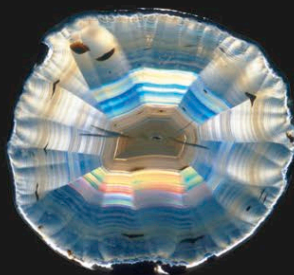
### Labradorite

When viewed from certain angles, this feldspar mineral displays an iridescent lustre known generally as the schiller effect (from the German word for "twinkle").



### Fire agate

The layering of limonite or iron oxide and silica within this mineral produces its vibrant colouring.



### Iris agate

The "iris" or rainbow effect can be achieved with backlighting on agate with fine colour banding.